

FREE SAMPLE

Lovebird Care Package

The first 5 pages of the 49-page printable manual, free to keep.



In this sample: What's inside, How to Use This Package, Quick Profile & Cost Overview, The Species, Colors, Size & Lifespan. The contents page shows every one of the 49 pages, so you can see exactly what the full package covers before you buy it.

Not in this sample: the 44 pages that follow, which are the full care guide, the health section, the quick reference cards, and the owner tools, checklists and logs.

The full package is \$8.99 at beastlyfacts.com/care-packages/lovebird/. One purchase, and every corrected edition is a free re-download from your library. The free lovebird care guide it was built from is at beastlyfacts.com/guides/lovebird/, and stays free.

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What's inside

Every page is written to be used, not just read once.

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START HERE

How to use this package

UNITS USED THROUGHOUT

Every temperature and size is given twice. Temperatures appear in degrees Fahrenheit (°F) with degrees Celsius (°C) beside them. Sizes appear in inches (in) and feet (ft), with centimeters (cm) and millimeters (mm) beside them. A lovebird and its food are weighed in grams (g), the unit a kitchen scale shows, and a bird's weight is also given in ounces (oz). Humidity, where it comes up, is a percentage (%). Prices are in United States dollars.

If you haven't bought a bird yet

Read pages 4 to 11 in order before buying anything. Two decisions are far harder to undo than the rest: the cage, on page 6, and whether you bring home one bird or two, on page 20. Settle those first, then use the Budget: Setup & Shopping List on page 35 to buy once instead of twice.

If your lovebird is already home

Audit what you have against the Setup Checklist in the print list below, and go to the Red Flags page (page 27) if anything seems off. If the cage contains a happy hut, a nest box or a mirror, read page 7 today: those three items drive more lovebird problems than anything else an owner adds on purpose.

Print these first

- | | |
|--|--|
| ☐ Page 33: Setup Checklist & Targets | ☐ Page 41: Pet-Sitter Sheet |
| ☐ Page 34: Emergency & Quick Targets Card | ☐ Page 42: Owner Log |
| ☐ Page 38: Symptom Quick Reference | ☐ Page 43: Equipment & Vet Log |
| ☐ Page 39: Daily, Weekly & Seasonal Routine | ☐ Page 44: Enrichment Checklist & Log |

WHY THIS PACKAGE EXISTS

Lovebird advice online swings between two extremes: treating them as disposable starter birds, or copying care written for parrots ten times their size. Neither fits. This edition reflects current feeding, cage, light and egg-laying guidance, cross-checked against the veterinary sources listed on page 47.

NOT A SUBSTITUTE FOR

An avian veterinarian experienced with small parrots. This is a husbandry reference for day-to-day care. Anything urgent or health-related is always a vet call, not a page in this book. Birds hide illness until they are genuinely sick, so find a vet before you need one. The Association of Avian Veterinarians keeps a find-a-vet directory of avian-experienced vets. Write the number on the emergency card.

Quick profile

Scientific name	<i>Agapornis</i> spp., nine species. The peach-faced (<i>A. roseicollis</i>) and Fischer's are the common pets
Adult size	5 to 6.5 in (13 to 16.5 cm); 40 to 60 g (1.5 to 2 oz)
Captive lifespan	10 to 15 years typical, up to about 20 with excellent care
Native range	Africa and Madagascar: savanna, open woodland and forest edge
Diet type	Seeds, grains, berries, grasses and some insects in the wild; a pellet-forward diet with fresh food in captivity (page 12)
Cage, single bird	18×18×24 in (46×46×61 cm) at the least; 3×2×2 ft (90×60×60 cm) is the better target (page 6)
Cage, bonded pair	24×18×24 in (61×46×61 cm) at the least
Bar spacing	3/8 to 5/8 in (10 to 16 mm), half an inch ideal. A safety figure, not a preference
Handling difficulty	Intermediate. Beaky and territorial for its size, and the one-or-two decision on page 20 sets how tame the bird gets
Conservation status	Most species Least Concern; Fischer's lovebird Near Threatened, on the IUCN (International Union for Conservation of Nature) list of threatened species

Cost overview

Initial setup

\$275 to \$600 for the setup, every item priced from the cage to the first bag of pellets, plus \$25 to \$50 for a first avian vet checkup. The bird itself is \$50 to \$150 for a common peach-faced or Fischer's, \$200 to \$400 or more for a rare color mutation, and \$20 to \$100 to adopt. Every line is on page 35.

Ongoing

\$20 to \$40 a month for one bird, which is \$260 to \$430 a year: pellets, fresh vegetables, replacement toys and the yearly vet check, averaged. A pair needs the larger cage and more of everything.

BUDGET FOR THE WORST CASE TOO

A routine avian checkup runs \$25 to \$50. An emergency does not: egg binding or an injury can run into the thousands. Egg binding is the likeliest emergency in this species and it is a same-day problem, so an emergency fund matters more here than the price of any item on the shopping list.

Fun facts worth knowing

- The name comes from the pair bond: bonded pairs spend hours preening each other and sitting pressed together. It describes how they treat each other, not how gently they treat people.
- A hen lays eggs with no male anywhere in the house. It is not a sign of anything going right, and page 24 is about keeping it from becoming a habit.
- Lovebirds shell their own seed, so unlike some cage birds they need no grit at all. Offering it risks a blockage for no benefit.

The species, colors, size & lifespan

A genus of nine small parrots

Agapornis is a genus of nine small parrot species from Africa and Madagascar, living in savanna, open woodland and forest edge on seeds, grains, berries, grasses and some insects. The pet trade sells mostly the peach-faced lovebird (*Agapornis roseicollis*) and Fischer's lovebird, and the care in this package applies to both. Wild lifespan is not known, though it is likely shorter than in captivity.

Colors

A common peach-faced or Fischer's costs \$50 to \$150. Rare color mutations such as lutino, blue and pied, and combinations of them, run \$200 to \$400 or more, and exceptional individuals reach \$1,000. The care is the same for every color. Adopting a bird typically costs \$20 to \$100.

Size and lifespan

Adult length	5 to 6.5 in (13 to 16.5 cm)
Adult weight	About 40 to 60 g (1.5 to 2 oz), though healthy birds are reported up to 70 g. Your own bird's steady number matters more than any range (page 17)
Males and females	They look alike. Nothing about plumage, size or shape reliably separates the sexes, and only a DNA (deoxyribonucleic acid) test settles it (page 24)
Lifespan	10 to 15 years typical in captivity, up to about 20 with excellent care

A lovebird is often sold as a casual, low-commitment pet. Plan for the whole span: a decade or more of the routine, the cage, and an avian vet for every one of those years.

HAND-RAISED OR PARENT-RAISED

A hand-raised bird costs more than a parent-raised one and is generally the better choice for a tame, interactive pet; a parent-raised bird can still make a fine companion, but expect more work getting there. Tameness has a price: a University of Bern study of African grey parrots found hand-reared birds imprint on a person and are more dependent on people, with more aggression, feather picking and stereotyped behavior than parent-reared birds. It is a caution to weigh, not a verdict, and most hand-raised birds live fine lives as companions.

TWO SPECIES ARE IN TROUBLE IN THE WILD

Fischer's lovebird is Near Threatened, and the black-cheeked lovebird is Vulnerable across its small range in Zambia after heavy trapping in the 1920s. Tanzania suspended export licenses for Fischer's lovebird in 1992 after the trade drained the wild population. Captive stock has been bred on its own line since, with a blue Fischer's first bred in South Africa in 1957.